

Most document generators optimize for visual variety — icons, gradients, accent palettes, rounded corners, illustrated divider graphics. This one does not. It aims to produce the same kind of page, over and over, with as little chrome as the content will tolerate.

Why

The point of a printed page is to be read.

- Every extra color is a decision the reader has to resolve.
- Every rounded corner is a style choice the reader has to accept.
- Every shadow is an attempt to imitate paper that paper itself does not need.

When those decisions aren't yours to make, the reader can just read.

What You Get

ELEMENT	TREATMENT
H1	Serif (IBM Plex Serif 700), ink-black, rule below
H2–H4	Same serif family, tighter hierarchy
Body	Lora, 11pt, 1.62 leading, true-italic for emphasis
Code	Light mono panel, accent keywords, language tag top-right
Tables	Uppercase-mono header in accent, no vertical borders
Links	Accent-colored underline, restrained
Callouts	Thin accent rule on the left — no bar, no fill
Header	Title left, author right, accent mono
Footer	<code>page / total</code> in accent mono, centered

The Five Knobs

Every document exposes the same five theme variables — two options each, built into the stylesheet, resolved from CLI, frontmatter, or project config:

VARIABLE	VALUES
A SHORT CASE FOR BORING OUTPUT	
paper-tone	cool-white · pure-white
accent	graphite · forest
body-font	lora · inter
heading-font	plex-serif · lora
density	normal · compact

Defaults are `cool-white`, `graphite`, `lora`, `plex-serif`, `normal` — the settings that need the least conscious override for most documents.

How

1. Extract frontmatter with `gray-matter`.
2. Parse Markdown to an mdast tree (`remark-parse` + `remark-gfm`).
3. Transform mdast → hast with `remark-rehype`.
4. Syntax-highlight with `@shikijs/rehype`, using a Shiki theme built from the resolved `paperTone` + `accent`.
5. Stringify to HTML, wrap in a shell whose `<html>` carries `data-paper-tone`, `data-accent`, `data-body-font`, `data-heading-font`, and `data-density`; one stylesheet handles every combination.
6. Drive headless Chromium through Playwright; emit the PDF.

Nothing in that list is novel. The novelty, if any, is in what's left out.

Code, For Flavor

TYPESCRIPT

```
const { content, frontmatter } = extractFrontmatter(raw);
const resolved = resolveOptions({ cli, frontmatter, project });
const tree = parseMarkdownToMdast(content);
const body = await mdastToHtml(tree, {
  paperTone: resolved.theme.paperTone,
  accent: resolved.theme.accent,
});
const html = wrapInDocumentShell(body, {
  title: resolved.title ?? deriveTitle(inputPath),
  baseUrl: pathToFileURL(dirname(inputPath) + "/").href,
  theme: resolved.theme,
});
```

One call per stage, one layer of configuration.

Three types, one source format — a `[!NOTE]`, `[!WARN]`, or `[!SYSTEM]` tag on the first line of a blockquote.

NOTE

Useful context that isn't load-bearing. A quiet aside the reader can take or leave.

WARN

Something the reader must not miss. The accent rule is enough signal; the tag above it is enough name.

SYSTEM

A diagnostic, an engineering invariant, or a pre-condition. A dashed rule reads as "from the machine, not the author."

A Note on Checklists

- ✓ ~~Five accent palettes.~~
- ✓ Two accent options, disciplined use.
- ✓ Header and footer in the same typographic voice.
- ☐ Cover page (Week 7).

The strikethrough, task list, and nested list all render from a single Markdown source — no special syntax, no escape hatches.

Closing

Design is a plan for arranging elements in such a way as best to accomplish a particular purpose.

— Charles Eames, who knew a thing or two about chairs.

If a boring page is readable, and a readable page gets read, the boring page has out-performed the interesting one. That is the whole case.